

Agriculture or Husbandry

This document focuses on **Agriculture or Husbandry**, which is defined as the cultivation of the earth.

- **Agriculture** is presented as **man's occupation before the fall**, but **cursed by God after the fall**. As a result, man is **doomed to labor** for his food.

- The text provides numerous **Bible verses** related to agriculture and husbandry to illustrate its importance and requirements.

- **Wisdom, diligence, toil, and patience** are all necessary for successful agriculture.
- The **providence of God** is evident in the produce of the earth, and **diligence in agriculture is rewarded** with a good harvest.

- **War** is portrayed as **destructive to agriculture**, while **peace** is favorable.
- The **Israelites** were **engaged in agriculture**, as were the **patriarchs**.
- **God's blessings** on agriculture are emphasized.
- The document also details **agricultural operations**, including **hedging, plowing, digging, manuring, harrowing, gathering stones, sowing, planting, watering, weeding, grafting, pruning, mowing, reaping, binding, gleaning, stacking, threshing, and winnowing**.

- **Oxen, asses, and horses** were used in agriculture, and various **implements** were used for different tasks.

The text concludes by highlighting **the spiritual significance of agriculture**, drawing parallels between **the cultivation of the earth and the cultivation of the Church and the heart**.

The cultivation of the earth.

Genesis 3:23. Therefore the LORD God sent him forth from the garden of Eden, to till the ground from whence he was taken.

The occupation of man before the fall.

Genesis 2:15. And the LORD God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and to keep it.

Rendered laborious by the curse on the earth.

Genesis 3:17-19. And unto Adam he said, Because thou hast hearkened unto the voice of thy wife, and hast eaten of the tree, of which I commanded thee, saying, Thou shalt not eat of it: cursed is the ground for thy sake; in sorrow shalt thou eat of it all the days of thy life; Thorns also and thistles shall it bring forth to thee; and thou shalt eat the herb of the field; In the sweat of thy face shalt thou eat bread, till thou return unto the ground; for out of it wast thou taken: for dust thou Art, and unto dust shalt thou return.

Man doomed to labor in, after the fall.

Genesis 3:23. Therefore the LORD God sent him forth from the garden of Eden, to till the ground from whence he was taken.

Contributes to the support of all.

Ecclesiastes 5:9. Moreover the profit of the earth is for all: the king himself is served by the field.

The providence of God to be acknowledged in the produce of.

Jeremiah 5:24. Neither say they in their heart, Let us now fear the LORD our God, that giveth Rain, both the former and the latter, in his season: he reserveth unto us the appointed weeks of the harvest.

Hosea 2:8. For she did not know that I gave her Corn, and wine, and oil, and multiplied her silver and gold, which they prepared for Baal.

REQUIRES

Wisdom.

Isaiah 28:26. For his God doth instruct him to discretion, and doth Teach him.

Diligence.

Proverbs 27:23-27. Be thou diligent to know the state of thy flocks, and look well to thy herds. For riches are not for ever: and doth the crown endure to every generation? The hay appeareth, and the tender grass sheweth itself, and herbs of the mountains are gathered. The lambs are for thy clothing, and the goats are the price of the field. ...

Ecclesiastes 11:6. In the morning sow thy seed, and in the evening withhold not thine hand: for thou knowest not whether shall prosper, either this or that, or whether they both shall be alike good.

Toil.

2 Timothy 2:6. The husbandman that laboureth must be first partaker of the fruits.

Patience in waiting.

James 5:7. Be Patient therefore, Brethren, unto the coming of the Lord. Behold, the husbandman waiteth for the precious fruit of the earth, and hath long Patience for it, until he receive the early and latter Rain.

Diligence in, abundantly recompensed.

Proverbs 12:11. He that tilleth his land shall be satisfied with bread: but he that followeth vain persons is void of understanding.

Proverbs 13:23. Much food is in the tillage of the poor: but there is that is destroyed for want of Judgment.

Proverbs 28:19. He that tilleth his land shall have plenty of bread: but he that followeth after vain persons shall have poverty enough.

Hebrews 6:7. For the earth which drinketh in the Rain that cometh oft upon it, and bringeth forth herbs meet for them by whom it is dressed, receiveth blessing from God:

PERSONS ENGAGED IN, CALLED

Tillers of the ground.

Genesis 4:2. And she again bare his brother Abel. And Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain was a tiller of the ground.

Husbandmen.

2 Chronicles 26:10. Also he built towers in the desert, and digged many wells: for he had much cattle, both in the low country, and in the plains: husbandmen also, and vine dressers in the mountains, and in Carmel: for he loved husbandry.

Laborers.

Matthew 9:37. Then saith he unto his disciples, The harvest truly is plenteous, but the labourers are few;

Matthew 20:1. For the Kingdom of Heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which went out early in the morning to hire labourers into his vineyard.

Peace favorable to.

Isaiah 2:4. And he shall Judge among the nations, and shall rebuke many people: and they shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruninghooks: nation shall not lift up sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more.

Jeremiah 31:24. And there shall dwell in Judah itself, and in all the cities thereof together, husbandmen, and they that go forth with flocks.

War destructive to.

Jeremiah 50:16. Cut off the sower from Babylon, and him that handleth the sickle in the time of harvest: for fear of the oppressing sword they shall turn every one to his people, and they shall flee every one to his own land.

Jeremiah 51:23. I will also break in pieces with thee the shepherd and his flock; and with thee will I break in pieces the husbandman and his yoke of oxen; and with thee will I break in pieces Captains and rulers.

Patriarchs engaged in.

Genesis 4:2. And she again bare his brother Abel. And Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain was a tiller of the ground.

Genesis 9:20. And Noah began to be an husbandman, and he planted a vineyard:

The labor of, supposed to be lessened by Noah.

Genesis 5:29. And he called his name Noah, saying, This same shall comfort us concerning our work and toil of our hands, because of the ground which the LORD hath cursed.

Genesis 9:20. And Noah began to be an husbandman, and he planted a vineyard:

The Jews loved and followed.

Judges 6:11. And there came an angel of the LORD, and sat under an oak which was in Ophrah, that pertained unto Joash the Abiezrite: and his son Gideon threshed wheat by the winepress, to hide it from the Midianites.

1 Kings 19:19. So he departed thence, and found Elisha the son of Shaphat, who was plowing with twelve yoke of oxen before him, and he with the twelfth: and Elijah passed by him, and cast his mantle upon him.

2 Chronicles 26:10. Also he built towers in the desert, and digged many wells: for he had much cattle, both in the low country, and in the plains: husbandmen also, and vine dressers in the mountains, and in Carmel: for he loved husbandry.

Soil of Canaan suited to.

Genesis 13:10. And Lot lifted up his eyes, and beheld all the plain of Jordan, that it was well watered every where, before the LORD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah, even as the garden of the LORD, like the land of Egypt, as thou comest unto Zoar.

Deuteronomy 8:7-9. For the LORD thy God bringeth thee into a good land, a land of brooks of water, of fountains and depths that spring out of valleys and hills; A land of wheat, and barley, and vines, and fig trees, and pomegranates; a land of oil olive, and honey; A land wherein thou shalt eat bread without scarceness, thou shalt not lack any thing in it; a land whose stones are iron, and out of whose hills thou mayest dig brass.

Climate of Canaan favorable to.

Deuteronomy 11:10-11. For the land, whither thou goest in to possess it, is not as the land of Egypt, from whence ye came out, where thou sowedst thy seed, and wateredst it with thy foot, as a garden of herbs: But the land, whither ye go to possess it, is a land of hills and valleys, and drinketh water of the Rain of heaven:

WAS PROMOTED AMONGST THE JEWS, BY

Allotments to each family.

Numbers 36:7-9. So shall not the inheritance of the children of Israel remove from tribe to tribe: for every one of the children of Israel shall keep himself to the inheritance of the tribe of his Fathers. And every daughter, that possesseth an inheritance in any tribe of the children of Israel, shall be wife unto one of the family of the tribe of her Father, that the children of Israel may enjoy every man the inheritance of his Fathers. Neither shall the inheritance remove from one tribe to another tribe; but every one of the tribes of the children of Israel shall keep himself to his own inheritance.

The rights of redemption.

Leviticus 25:23-28. The land shall not be sold for ever: for the land is mine; for ye are strangers and sojourners with me. And in all the land of your possession ye shall grant a redemption for the land. If thy brother be waxen poor, and hath sold away some of his possession, and if any of his kin come to redeem it, then shall he redeem that which his brother sold. And if the man have none to redeem it, and himself be able to redeem it; ...

Separation from other nations.

Exodus 33:16. For wherein shall it be known here that I and thy people have found grace in thy sight? is it not in that thou goest with us? so shall we be separated, I and thy people, from all the people that are upon the face of the earth.

The prohibition against usury.

Exodus 22:25. If thou lend money to any of my people that is poor by thee, thou shalt not be to him as an usurer, neither shalt thou lay upon him usury.

The promises of God's blessings on.

Leviticus 26:4. Then I will give you Rain in due season, and the land shall yield her increase, and the trees of the field shall yield their fruit.

Deuteronomy 7:13. And he will love thee, and bless thee, and multiply thee: he will also bless the fruit of thy womb, and the fruit of thy land, thy Corn, and thy wine, and thine oil, the increase of thy kine, and the flocks of thy sheep, in the land which he sware unto thy Fathers to give thee.

Deuteronomy 11:14-15. That I will give you the Rain of your land in his due season, the first Rain and the latter Rain, that thou mayest gather in thy Corn, and thy wine, and thine oil. 15 And I will send grass in thy fields for thy cattle, that thou mayest eat and be full.

ENACTMENTS TO PROTECT;

Not to Covet the fields of another.

Deuteronomy 5:21. Neither shalt thou desire thy neighbour's wife, neither shalt thou Covet thy neighbour's house, his field, or his manservant, or his maidservant, his ox, or his ass, or any thing that is thy neighbour's.

Not to move landmarks.

Deuteronomy 19:14. Thou shalt not remove thy neighbour's landmark, which they of old time have set in thine inheritance, which thou shalt inherit in the land that the LORD thy God giveth thee to possess it.

Proverbs 22:28. Remove not the ancient landmark, which thy Fathers have set.

Not to cut down crops of another.

Deuteronomy 23:25. When thou comest into the standing Corn of thy neighbour, then thou mayest pluck the ears with thine hand; but thou shalt not move a sickle unto thy neighbour's standing Corn.

Against the trespass of cattle.

Exodus 22:5. If a man shall cause a field or vineyard to be eaten, and shall put in his beast, and shall feed in another man's field; of the best of his own field, and of the best of his own vineyard, shall he make restitution.

Against injuring the produce of.

Exodus 22:6. If fire break out, and catch in thorns, so that the stacks of Corn, or the standing Corn, or the field, be consumed therewith; he that kindled the fire shall surely make restitution.

Often performed by hirelings.

1 Chronicles 27:26. And over them that did the work of the field for tillage of the ground was Ezri the son of Chelub:

2 Chronicles 26:10. Also he built towers in the desert, and digged many wells: for he had much cattle, both in the low country, and in the plains: husbandmen also, and vine dressers in the mountains, and in Carmel: for he loved husbandry.

Matthew 20:8. So when even was come, the lord of the vineyard saith unto his steward, Call the labourers, and give them their hire, beginning from the last unto the first.

Luke 17:7. But which of you, having a Servant plowing or feeding cattle, will say unto him By and by, when he is come from the field, Go and sit down to meat?

Not to be engaged in during the Sabbatical year.

Exodus 23:10-11. And six years thou shalt sow thy land, and shalt gather in the fruits thereof: But the seventh year thou shalt let it rest and lie still; that the poor of thy people may eat: and what they leave the beasts of the field shall eat. In like manner thou shalt deal with thy vineyard, and with thy oliveyard.

Produce of, given as rent for land.

Matthew 21:33-34. Hear another parable: There was a certain householder, which planted a vineyard, and hedged it round about, and digged a winepress in it, and built a tower, and let it out to husbandmen, and went into a far country: And when the time of the fruit drew near, he sent his servants to the husbandmen, that they might receive the fruits of it.

Produce of, often blasted because of sin.

Isaiah 5:10. Yea, ten acres of vineyard shall yield one bath, and the seed of an homer shall yield an ephah.

Isaiah 7:23. And it shall come to pass in that day, that every place shall be, where there were a thousand vines at a thousand silverlings, it shall even be for briers and thorns.

Jeremiah 12:13. They have sown wheat, but shall reap thorns: they have put themselves to pain, but shall not profit: and they shall be ashamed of your revenues because of the fierce Anger of the LORD.

Joel 1:10-11. The field is wasted, the land mourneth; for the Corn is wasted: the new wine is dried up, the oil languisheth. Be ye ashamed, O ye husbandmen; howl, O ye vinedressers, for the wheat and for the barley; because the harvest of the field is perished.

Grief occasioned by the failure of the fruits of.

Joel 1:11. Be ye ashamed, O ye husbandmen; howl, O ye vinedressers, for the wheat and for the barley; because the harvest of the field is perished.

Amos 5:16-17. Therefore the LORD, the God of hosts, the Lord, saith thus; Wailing shall be in all streets; and they shall say in all the highways, Alas! alas! and they shall call the husbandman to mourning, and such as are skilful of lamentation to wailing. And in all vineyards shall be wailing: for I will pass through thee, saith the LORD.

Produce of, exported.

1 Kings 5:11. And Solomon gave Hiram twenty thousand measures of wheat for food to his household, and twenty measures of pure oil: thus gave Solomon to Hiram year by year.

Ezekiel 27:17. Judah, and the land of Israel, they were thy merchants: they traded in thy market wheat of Minnith, and Pannag, and honey, and oil, and Balm.

OPERATIONS IN;

Hedging.

Isaiah 5:2. And he fenced it, and gathered out the stones thereof, and planted it with the choicest vine, and built a tower in the midst of it, and also made a winepress therein: and he looked that it should bring forth grapes, and it brought forth wild grapes.

Isaiah 5:5. And now go to; I will tell you what I will do to my vineyard: I will take away the hedge thereof, and it shall be eaten up; and break down the wall thereof, and it shall be trodden down:

Plowing.

Job 1:14. And there came a messenger unto Job, and said, The oxen were plowing, and the asses feeding beside them:

Digging.

Isaiah 5:6. And I will lay it waste: it shall not be pruned, nor digged; but there shall come up briers and thorns: I will also command the clouds that they Rain no Rain upon it.

Luke 13:8. And he answering said unto him, Lord, let it alone this year also, till I shall dig about it, and dung it:

Luke 16:3. Then the steward said within himself, What shall I do? for my lord taketh away from me the stewardship: I cannot dig; to beg I am ashamed.

Manuring.

Isaiah 25:10. For in this mountain shall the hand of the LORD rest, and Moab shall be trodden down under him, even as straw is trodden down for the dunghill.

Luke 14:34-35. Salt is good: but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be seasoned? It is neither fit for the land, nor yet for the dunghill; but men cast it out. He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.

Harrowing.

Job 39:10. Canst thou bind the unicorn with his band in the furrow? or will he harrow the valleys after thee?

Isaiah 28:24. Doth the plowman plow all day to sow? doth he open and break the clods of his ground?

Gathering out the stones.

Isaiah 5:2. And he fenced it, and gathered out the stones thereof, and planted it with the choicest vine, and built a tower in the midst of it, and also made a winepress therein: and he looked that it should bring forth grapes, and it brought forth wild grapes.

Sowing.

Ecclesiastes 11:4. He that observeth the wind shall not sow; and he that regardeth the clouds shall not reap.

Isaiah 32:20. Blessed are ye that sow beside all waters, that send forth thither the feet of the ox and the ass.

Matthew 13:3. And he spake many things unto them in parables, saying, Behold, a sower went forth to sow;

Planting.

Proverbs 31:16. She considereth a field, and buyeth it: with the fruit of her hands she planteth a vineyard.

Isaiah 44:14. He heweth him down cedars, and taketh the cypress and the oak, which he strengtheneth for himself among the trees of the forest: he planteth an ash, and the Rain doth nourish it.

Jeremiah 31:5. Thou shalt yet plant vines upon the mountains of Samaria: the planters shall plant, and shall eat them as common things.

Watering.

Deuteronomy 11:10. For the land, whither thou goest in to possess it, is not as the land of Egypt, from whence ye came out, where thou sowedst thy seed, and wateredst it with thy foot, as a garden of herbs:

1 Corinthians 3:6-8. I have planted, Apollos watered; but God gave the increase. So then neither is he that planteth any thing, neither he that watereth; but God that giveth the increase. Now he that planteth and he that watereth are one: and every man shall receive his own reward according to his own labour.

Weeding.

Matthew 13:28. He said unto them, An enemy hath done this. The servants said unto him, Wilt thou then that we go and gather them up?

Grafting.

Romans 11:17-19. And if some of the branches be broken off, and thou, being a wild olive tree, wert grafted in among them, and with them partakest of the root and fatness of the olive tree; Boast not against the branches. But if thou boast, thou bearest not the root, but the root thee. Thou wilt say then, The branches were broken off, that I might be grafted in.

Romans 11:24. For if thou wert cut out of the olive tree which is wild by nature, and wert grafted contrary to nature into a good olive tree: how much more shall these, which be the

natural branches, be grafted into their own olive tree?

Pruning.

Leviticus 25:3. Six years thou shalt sow thy field, and six years thou shalt prune thy vineyard, and gather in the fruit thereof;

Isaiah 5:6. And I will lay it waste: it shall not be pruned, nor digged; but there shall come up briars and thorns: I will also command the clouds that they Rain no Rain upon it.

John 15:2. Every branch in me that beareth not fruit he taketh away: and every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit.

Mowing.

Psalms 129:7. Wherewith the mower filleth not his hand; nor he that bindeth sheaves his bosom.

Amos 7:1. Thus hath the Lord GOD shewed unto me; and, behold, he formed grasshoppers in the beginning of the shooting up of the latter growth; and, lo, it was the latter growth after the king's mowings.

Reaping.

Isaiah 17:5. And it shall be as when the harvestman gathereth the Corn, and reapeth the ears with his arm; and it shall be as he that gathereth ears in the valley of Rephaim.

Binding.

Genesis 37:7. For, behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and, lo, my sheaf arose, and also stood upright; and, behold, your sheaves stood round about, and made obeisance to my sheaf.

Matthew 13:30. Let both grow together until the harvest: and in the time of harvest I will say to the reapers, Gather ye together first the tares, and bind them in bundles to burn them: but gather the wheat into my barn.

Gleaning.

Leviticus 19:9. And when ye reap the harvest of your land, thou shalt not wholly reap the corners of thy field, neither shalt thou gather the gleanings of thy harvest.

Ruth 2:3. And she went, and came, and gleaned in the field after the reapers: and her hap was to Light on a part of the field belonging unto Boaz, who was of the kindred of Elimelech.

Stacking.

Exodus 22:6. If fire break out, and catch in thorns, so that the stacks of Corn, or the standing Corn, or the field, be consumed therewith; he that kindled the fire shall surely make restitution.

Threshing.

Deuteronomy 25:4. Thou shalt not muzzle the ox when he treadeth out the Corn.

Judges 6:11. And there came an angel of the LORD, and sat under an oak which was in Ophrah, that pertained unto Joash the Abiezrite: and his son Gideon threshed wheat by the winepress, to hide it from the Midianites.

Winnowing.

Ruth 3:2. And now is not Boaz of our kindred, with whose maidens thou wast? Behold, he winnoweth barley to night in the threshingfloor.

Matthew 3:12. Whose fan is in his hand, and he will thoroughly purge his floor, and gather his wheat into the garner; but he will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.

Storing in barns.

Matthew 6:26. Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feedeth them. Are ye not much better than they?

Matthew 13:30. Let both grow together until the harvest: and in the time of harvest I will say to the reapers, Gather ye together first the tares, and bind them in bundles to burn them: but gather the wheat into my barn.

BEASTS USED IN;

The ox.

Deuteronomy 25:4. Thou shalt not muzzle the ox when he treadeth out the Corn.

The ass.

Deuteronomy 22:10. Thou shalt not plow with an ox and an Ass together.

The horse.

Isaiah 28:28. Bread Corn is bruised; because he will not ever be threshing it, nor break it with the wheel of his cart, nor bruise it with his horsemen.

IMPLEMENTS OF;

The plow.

1 Samuel 13:20. But all the Israelites went down to the Philistines, to sharpen every man his share, and his Coulter, and his axe, and his mattock.

The harrow.

2 Samuel 12:31. And he brought forth the people that were therein, and put them under saws, and under harrows of iron, and under axes of iron, and made them pass through the brickkiln: and thus did he unto all the cities of the children of Ammon. So David and all the people returned unto Jerusalem.

The mattock.

1 Samuel 13:20. But all the Israelites went down to the Philistines, to sharpen every man his share, and his Coulter, and his axe, and his mattock.

Isaiah 7:25. And on all hills that shall be digged with the mattock, there shall not come thither the fear of briers and thorns: but it shall be for the sending forth of oxen, and for the treading of lesser cattle.

The sickle.

Deuteronomy 16:9. Seven weeks shalt thou number unto thee: begin to number the seven weeks from such time as thou beginnest to put the sickle to the Corn.

Deuteronomy 23:25. When thou comest into the standing Corn of thy neighbour, then thou

mayest pluck the ears with thine hand; but thou shalt not move a sickle unto thy neighbour's standing Corn.

The pruning-hook.

Isaiah 18:5. For Afore the harvest, when the bud is perfect, and the sour grape is ripening in the flower, he shall both cut off the sprigs with pruning hooks, and take away and cut down the branches.

Joel 3:10. Beat your plowshares into swords, and your pruninghooks into spears: let the weak say, I am strong.

The fork.

1 Samuel 13:21. Yet they had a file for the mattocks, and for the coulter, and for the forks, and for the axes, and to sharpen the goads.

The axe.

1 Samuel 13:20. But all the Israelites went down to the Philistines, to sharpen every man his share, and his Coulter, and his axe, and his mattock.

The toothed threshing instrument.

Isaiah 41:15. Behold, I will make thee a new sharp threshing instrument having teeth: thou shalt thresh the mountains, and beat them small, and shalt make the hills as chaff.

The flail,

Isaiah 28:27. For the fitches are not threshed with a threshing instrument, neither is a cart wheel turned about upon the Cummin; but the fitches are beaten out with a staff, and the Cummin with a rod.

The cart.

1 Samuel 6:7. Now therefore make a new cart, and take two milch kine, on which there hath come no yoke, and tie the kine to the cart, and bring their calves home from them:

Isaiah 28:27-28. For the fitches are not threshed with a threshing instrument, neither is a cart wheel turned about upon the Cummin; but the fitches are beaten out with a staff, and the Cummin with a rod. Bread Corn is bruised; because he will not ever be threshing it, nor break it with the wheel of his cart, nor bruise it with his horsemen.

The shovel.

Isaiah 30:24. The oxen likewise and the young asses that ear the ground shall eat clean provender, which hath been winnowed with the shovel and with the fan.

The sieve.

Amos 9:9. For, lo, I will command, and I will sift the house of Israel among all nations, like as Corn is sifted in a sieve, yet shall not the least grain fall upon the earth.

The fan.

Isaiah 30:24. The oxen likewise and the young asses that ear the ground shall eat clean provender, which hath been winnowed with the shovel and with the fan.

Matthew 3:12. Whose fan is in his hand, and he will thoroughly purge his floor, and gather his wheat into the garner; but he will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.

ILLUSTRATIVE OF THE

Culture of the Church.

1 Corinthians 3:9. For we are labourers together with God: ye are God's husbandry, ye are God's building.

Culture of the heart.

Jeremiah 4:3. For thus saith the LORD to the men of Judah and Jerusalem, Break up your fallow ground, and sow not among thorns.

Hosea 10:12. Sow to yourselves in righteousness, reap in mercy; break up your fallow ground: for it is time to seek the LORD, till he come and Rain righteousness upon you.

